

into the forests. Soon, every other citizen rose to the tinkle of a Farben plastic-clock, rolled back a new synthetic-fabric spread. Every other man shaved with Farben soap that had been made from the residue of the paraffin that had been made from the coal! At least twice a week, the German ate a new Farben food cooked in synthetic fat. Six out of ten dinner tables were spread with Farben cloths. After the worker went to his job, his wife cleaned the linen, the curtains, the casements and dusted the furniture goods - - all made from beechwood. Until the Four-Year Plan began, Germany had imported 700 Million Reichsmarks worth of cotton, wool and other raw textiles every year. But in 1937, Farben's production of staple-fibres reached such gigantic figures that the Vorstand could predict their 1938 achievement - 180,000 metric tons of staple fibres, 60,000 tons of artificial silk - - more than half of Germany's textile raw materials.

Back from the forest Farben had brought beechwood to the giant Wolfen factory which also made photo film. Wolfen made the textiles which in two and a half years reduced Germany's import-expenditures from 700 million Reichsmarks a year to 350 million.

Every German worker washed his hands in the monopoly-suds of Farben detergents, on which every single soap factory in Germany depended. Many workers used Farben-made tools, sat on Farben plastic chairs, worked at plastic benches - and the odds were that even his apron was of Farben artificial leather. For by 1938, Farben had reduced the import of skins to a few shiploads. And Farben improved common-woods and plastics had done much to cut the 200 million Reichsmarks in wood-imports.

While clothing the householders and setting the table of total war economy, synthetics created a revolution in the older war industries. Germany had little copper; Farben replaced it with aluminum and magnesium. Magnesium to make airplanes and some motorized vehicles, produced out of pure German materials. When the Four-Year Plan began, Germany was importing the bauxite to make aluminum, but Krauch's Office